low and is used only for limited periods of time. The liquid diet is used

i) to keep fecal matter in the colon at a minimum

ii) after surgery

iii) to replace fluids lost from vomiting or diarrhoea.



Fluid Diet

Liquid diets may be clear- liquid or full liquid diet.

Clear Fluid Diet: This diet is made up of clear fluids that leave no residue, and it is non gas forming, non irritating and non stimulating to peristaltic action. This diet can meet the requirement of fluids and some minerals and can be given in 1 to 2 hour intervals and its use is typically limited to 24 to 36 hours. This diet is given during acute infection, following operations of colon or rectum, diarrhoea and vomiting. The foods which can be included are barley water, dhal water, whey water, tea and coffee without milk.

Full Fluid Diet: This diet bridges the gap between the clear fluid and soft diet. In this diet, foods which are liquid or which readily become liquid on reaching the stomach are given. It is used following operations, in acute gastritis, acute infections and in diarrhoea. This diet is given at 2 - 4 hours interval. The foods included are kanji, milk shakes, lassi and soups.

ii Soft Diet

It is used in acute infections, following surgery, and for patients who are unable to chew. The soft diet is made up of simple, easily digested food and contains no harsh fibre and no rich seasoned food. In this diet, three meals with intermediate feedings should be given; Patients with dental problems are given mechanically soft diet. The foods include cooked dhals, double cooked cereals, custard, and steamed bananas, purees.



Soft Diet

iii Mechanically Altered Diet

It differs from normal diet in texture and seasonings, depending on the needs of the patient. Mechanically altered diet is limited to soft food for those who have difficulty chewing food because of missing teeth or poorly fitting dentures. Eg. Puffed rice, gruels, purees, minced meat and desserts like custard.



Mechanically Altered Diet

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